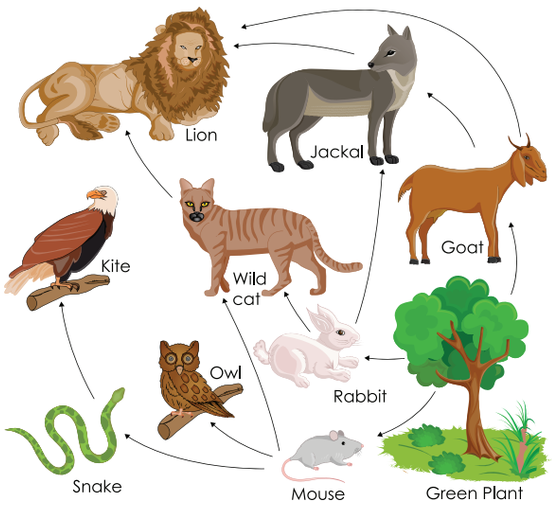


Food Web

4.3 Waste Management and Recycling

To protect our environment, it is very important to reduce waste, manage it properly and maximise recycling. Waste is any substance or material that has been used but is not wanted anymore. This is either because it is worn out, broken or no longer has any purpose. Everyone produces waste which has an impact on all ecosystems. However, most of us do not know where our garbage goes. There are many types of waste. There is liquid waste (in our drains), there are gases hiding in the air (like pollutants from factories) and there is solid waste (garbage) we put in our waste bins.

4.4 Biodegradable and Non-biodegradable Waste

Solid waste we generate can be classified into two major types:

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1. Biodegradable wastes

2. Non-biodegradable wastes

Activity 3:

Take two mud pots or glass jars and fill them up with garden soil. In the first pot, mix wastes such as banana peel, some vegetable peels and a few tree leaves into the soil. In the second pot, mix a piece of plastic carry bag, sweet wrapper and metal foil into the soil.

What happen to the waste materials placed in both pots? Do you notice a difference between first and second pot? Observe the changes over two weeks and discuss with your classmates.

Biodegradable waste

The term **'Biodegradable'** is used for those things that can be easily



decomposed by natural agents like water, oxygen, ultraviolet rays of the sun and micro-organisms, etc.

One can notice that when a dead leaf or a banana peel is thrown outside,

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